

strongest isolation · highest cost per tenant · lowest density

1 · SILO — instance per tenant
separate app + database + infrastructure

2 · DATABASE PER TENANT
shared application, one database each

3 · SCHEMA PER TENANT
shared database, a separate schema each

4 · POOLED — shared schema
every table carries a tenant_id column

weakest isolation · cheapest per tenant · highest density

5 · HYBRID / BRIDGE
pooled by default, siloed for the largest tenants

Most B2B SaaS starts at 4 and grows into 5.
The question is never "which is best" but
"what does this customer's contract require?"